Certificate in Financial Planning: any major, and transfers

Advising one-pager · students outside the business college (Gatton), and transfer students · 2026-27 catalog

Scan: how to add it

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Investment banking or private equity: Investment Banking. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/roadmaps

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of $105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Each course needs a C or better. No business courses are needed first; only FIN 359 must come after the others.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	Note
Fundamentals	**FIN 350**	Fall, spring	Its 60-credit-hour prerequisite can be waived: email the director
Tax	**ACC 357**	Fall only	ACC 407 also counts, but only for Accounting majors and double majors
Investment	**FIN 357**	Fall, spring	
Estate	**ACC 457**	Fall, spring	Its tax prerequisite is waived for certificate students
Retirement	**FIN 358**	Fall, spring	No alternate course
Capstone	**FIN 359**	Fall, spring	Taken last

In most majors outside Gatton all six are **free electives**, and every one is 300- or 400-level, so they also count toward upper-division hours. Check the degree audit in myGPS for elective room.

Plan it by starting term

Start	Semester 1	Semester 2	Semester 3	Semester 4
Fall start	**FIN 350**, **ACC 357**	**FIN 357**, **ACC 457**	**FIN 358**	**FIN 359**
Spring start	**FIN 350**, **FIN 357**	**ACC 357**, **FIN 358**	**ACC 457**	**FIN 359**
Faster, fall start	**FIN 350**, **ACC 357**, **FIN 358**	**FIN 357**, **ACC 457**	**FIN 359**	
Faster, spring start	**FIN 350**, **FIN 357**, **FIN 358**	**ACC 357**, **ACC 457**	**FIN 359**	

Certificate course One term only

Transfer students

- **New to UK?** A transfer student can start the certificate right away, including in the first semester at UK.
- **Completed CFP coursework at another CFP Board Registered Program?** Talk with the program director before registering.

Three things to know

1. **Any major, no extra tuition.** Six upper-division electives, 18 credit hours, open to every college. Little elective room may mean a heavier term, or finishing after graduation through Executive Education.
2. **Take ACC 357 in a fall.** It is the one course that runs in a single term, so a student who reaches senior spring without it cannot finish before graduating (Executive Education afterward costs $895 a course).
3. **Follow the row for the starting term.** ACC 357 runs only in fall, so it sets the order.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. Experience (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can follow the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student: it needs no sponsoring firm and is not required for the CFP.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning (adds the certificate, not a second major). Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. Upper-division: courses numbered 300 and above. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam.

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Sequences follow the program's recommended pacing; the catalog year a student entered under governs.

A general guide, not official advising. Compiled from publicly posted UK catalog and curriculum pages; requirements change and no warranty is given. Confirm your plan with your academic advisor and your myUK GPS degree audit.